



PORTABLE OPERATING & CAMPING CHECKLIST

Pack the radio. Pick a place. Be ready when you get there.

FIELD TIP: EXTRA COAX + EXTRA ANTENNA

A backup antenna and enough feedline can turn a problem into a successful activation.

01 Portable Operator Checklist

Use this as a general packing list for POTA activations, portable operating, field days, and other outdoor radio adventures. Your exact setup may require additional equipment.

RADIO & POWER

- Portable transceiver / HT / HF rig
- Microphone, speaker mic, or headset
- Battery pack(s) — bring enough for the entire operating period
- 12V power supply or portable power station
- Power cables and connectors for your radio
- Spare fuses
- Battery charger(s) and charging cables
- Power bank for phone and accessories

ANTENNAS & FEEDLINE

- **Extra coax** — bring more than you think you need
- **Extra antenna** — a backup can save an activation
- Primary antenna and all mounting hardware
- Spare antenna / backup antenna
- Coax adapters, barrels, PL-259/SO-239 adapters as needed
- SWR / power meter or antenna analyzer
- Antenna tuner if your setup requires one
- Mast, telescoping pole, tripod, or other support
- Guy lines, stakes, clips, and throw line if needed
- Radials / counterpoise wire for your antenna
- Coax choke / common-mode protection if part of your setup
- Weatherproofing tape or electrical tape

OPERATING & LOGGING

- Logging notebook or logging app / computer
- Pens, pencils, and a backup writing instrument
- Phone / tablet / laptop if used for logging
- Headphones or earbuds
- Printed frequency / band plan or quick-reference sheet
- Park reference, activation information, or POTA details
- Clock / timer if you use one for operating or logging
- Backup radio or HT when practical

TOOLS & FIELD REPAIRS

- Small multi-tool / screwdriver set
- Electrical tape and zip ties
- Extra connectors, adapters, and short jumper coax
- Wire cutters / small pliers
- Spare antenna hardware
- Small roll of rope or paracord
- Portable work light or headlamp
- Plastic bags or cases to keep connectors dry and clean

WEATHER & OPERATOR COMFORT

- Rain cover / small tarp for the radio table
- Sun shade or canopy when appropriate
- Chair and small operating table
- Bug repellent
- Sunscreen
- Water and snacks
- Hand sanitizer / wipes
- Warm or dry layer for changing weather

CAMPING CHECKLIST

Bring what keeps you comfortable, fed, dry, safe, and ready for the next adventure.

02 Camping Checklist

SHELTER & SLEEP

- Tent, tent poles, rainfly, and footprint
- Tent stakes and a few extras
- Sleeping bag or bedding appropriate for the forecast
- Sleeping pad / air mattress
- Pillow
- Small tarp or emergency shelter

CAMP KITCHEN & FOOD

- Food and snacks
- Drinking water — plus extra
- Cooler and ice
- Camp stove / grill if permitted
- Fuel / propane
- Pot, pan, coffee gear, and cookware
- Plate / bowl, cup, fork, spoon, knife
- Can opener / bottle opener
- Paper towels and trash bags
- Food storage containers
- Campfire supplies if fires are permitted

CLOTHING & PERSONAL GEAR

- Weather-appropriate clothing
- Extra socks and underwear
- Rain jacket / rain gear
- Hat and sunglasses
- Hiking shoes or boots
- Sandals / camp shoes
- Towel
- Toiletries and personal hygiene items
- Toilet paper / personal wipes
- Prescription and routine personal items

SAFETY & SITE ESSENTIALS

- First-aid kit
- Flashlight / headlamp
- Extra batteries
- Phone and charging cable
- Portable power bank
- Sunscreen and insect repellent
- Basic emergency supplies
- Map / park information
- Identification, permits, reservations, and campground information
- Cash / payment method
- Firewood only if allowed — follow campground rules
- Know the park's weather, wildlife, fire, and seasonal restrictions

CAMP FURNITURE & EXTRAS

- Camp chair
- Small table
- Lantern
- Ground tarp / mat
- Rope / paracord
- Multi-tool
- Binoculars / camera if desired
- Daypack for exploring
- Trash bags — leave your site cleaner than you found it

KENTUCKY PORTABLE CLUB

Portable ham radio • camping • adventure • community
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